

---BREAKDOWNS---

The Big Sciota

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, G, C, D, D, G, G, D, D, Em, Em, C, D, D, G.

The main melody is written in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The accompaniment is in the same key and 4/4 time. The melody features a triplet of eighth notes at the end of the first line. The accompaniment consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some chords marked above the staff.

Variation 1

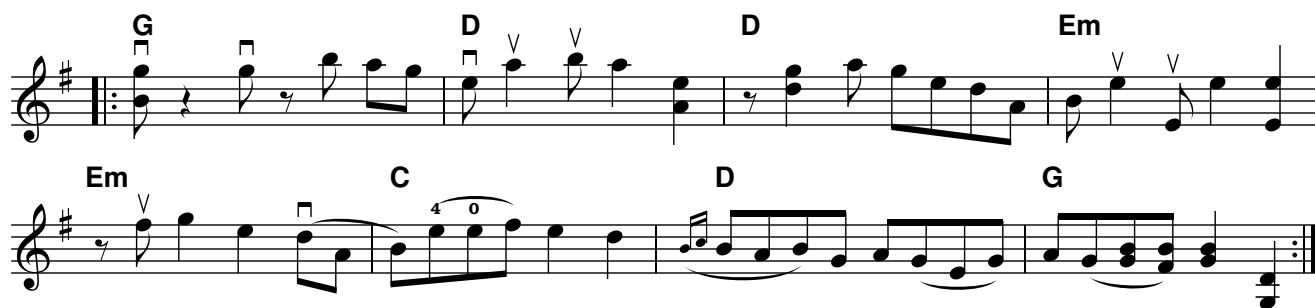
Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, G, C, D, D, G, G, D, D, Em, Em, C, D, D, G.

Variation 1 features a more complex melody with many slurs and grace notes. The accompaniment also includes slurs and grace notes, with some chords marked above the staff. The key signature remains one sharp (F#).

Variation 2

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, G, C, D, G.

Variation 2 features a simpler melody with many slurs and grace notes. The accompaniment also includes slurs and grace notes, with some chords marked above the staff. The key signature remains one sharp (F#).



Bitter Creek

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G C G D

G C D G

G C G D

G C D G

{B}

G C G D

G C D G

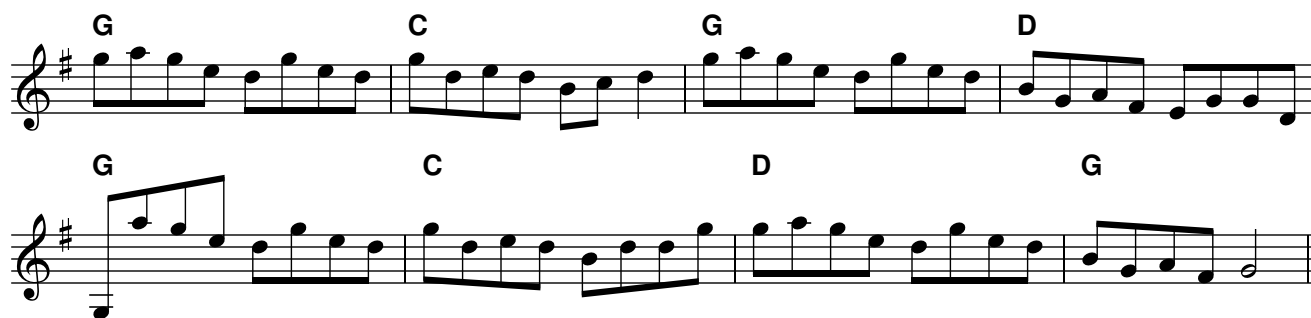
G C G D

G C D G

{A} (var.)

G C G D

G C D G



Source: A-part var. by Oscar Harper at https://tunearch.org/wiki/Bitter_Creek.

Blackberry Blossom

Trad.
reel

$\mathcal{D} = 105$

The image displays a musical score for the song "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. The score is written for guitar and includes a melody line. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff, and the guitar chords are indicated by letters above the staff. The chords are: G, F#m, C, G, C, G, A, D, G, F#m, C, G, C, G, D, G, Em, Em/G, B7, B7/F#, Em, A, D, G. The melody consists of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. The score is divided into four systems, each containing a staff of music and a line of guitar chords. The first system has 8 measures, the second has 8 measures, the third has 4 measures, and the fourth has 4 measures. The song ends with a double bar line and repeat dots in the final measure of the fourth system.

Variation 1

The image displays a musical score for guitar, consisting of six staves of music. The key signature is G major (one sharp). The chords and techniques indicated are as follows:

- Staff 1:** G, F#m, C, G, C, G, A, D.
- Staff 2:** G, F#m, C, G, C, G, D, G. Techniques include vibrato (V), a triplet (3), and a natural sign (♮).
- Staff 3:** G, F#m, C, G, C, G, A, D. Techniques include a triplet (3) and vibrato (V).
- Staff 4:** G, F#m, C, G, C, G, D, G. Techniques include a triplet (3), vibrato (V), and a natural sign (♮).
- Staff 5:** Em, Em/G, B7, B7/F#.
- Staff 6:** Em, A, D, G. Techniques include a triplet (3) and vibrato (V).

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 2

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 3

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G ³ D G
 G F#m C G C G A D
 G F#m C G C G D G
 Em Em/G B7 B7/F#
 Em A D G
 Em Em/G B7 B7/F#
 Em A D G ³

Notes: Thanks to Chris Daring for the transcription!

Done Gone

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 110$

A-part **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** | 1 **F** | 2 **F** **B $\flat$** |

B-part **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **F**

B $\flat$ **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **F** **F** **B $\flat$**

C-part **Gm** **D7**

Gm **D7** **Gm**

---HORNPIPES AND REELS---

The Bamburgh Rants

The Collpitts, The General Gordon, and Ye Old Elm Tree

Martin Matthews
rant

♩ = 105
Collpitts Rant

General Gordon Rant

The image displays a musical score for the song "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. The score is written for guitar and includes a four-measure solo. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The score is organized into four staves, each with guitar chords indicated above the notes. The chords are: G, C, Am, D, G, C, G, C, G, D, G, C, C/C#, D, G, G/G#, A, D, Em, C, D, and G. The solo is marked with a 'V' and a '4' over a measure. The score includes repeat signs and a double bar line at the end.

Ye Old Elm Tree Rant

The musical score for 'Ye Old Elm Tree Rant' is written in A major (three sharps) and 4/4 time. It consists of four staves of music. The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a key signature change to A major. The second staff ends with a repeat sign. The third staff begins with a repeat sign. The fourth staff includes various ornaments (V) and triplets (3). The chords are labeled as follows:

- Staff 1: A, D, A, D, B7, E
- Staff 2: A, D, A, D, E, A
- Staff 3: E, F#m, D, E
- Staff 4: A, D, E, A, D, A, E, A

Source: _Colpitts to Elm Tree_. See recording at <https://youtu.be/LkPSt-0y4q0?si=icA6Cvp1B5L5daSQ>.

Notes: These are named after the 3 pubs which have hosted the Monday session in Durham over the last 50 years.

Blackbird Hornpipe (1)

Trad.
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D G C

D C D

D G C

D C D

{B}

D G D A7

D G C D

D G D A7

D G C D

{B} (low)

D G D A7

D G C D

Source: Amanda Kerr; Randal Bays + Dave Marshall (with my own licks added)

Blackbird Hornpipe (2)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D C D A7 D

{B}

D G D

D G D

{C}

D C D

D C D

Source: Padraig McGovern and Peter Carberry: <https://youtu.be/5vidJn-Ebyc?si=eCc98qBibmGQ52gS>

Notes: This is another version of the Blackbird Hornpipe, clearly related to the previous one.

A little more repetitive, but in a good way! Good as a reference.

Chording remains basic / uncertain.

Boil The Breakfast Early

reel



Brenda Stubbert's Reel

a.k.a. Frosty Morning

*Jerry Holland
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Am G

Am Em G Em Am

{B}

Am G

1 F C Em Am

2 Am G Em Am

Source: Ashley MacIsaac (Hi(tm) How Are You Today?, 1995)

Notes: Ashley plays it in Bb, but the standard key is A Dorian. I like his accidentals.

Butterfly Hornpipe

(a.k.a. Dew Drop)

Trad.
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

First system of musical notation (measures 1-4) in treble clef, key of A major (two sharps), 4/4 time. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes. Chords are indicated above the staff: A (measures 1-2), B7 (measure 3), and E (measure 4). Measure 4 includes a triplet of eighth notes and a fermata over the final note.

Second system of musical notation (measures 5-8) in treble clef, key of A major. The melody continues with eighth and sixteenth notes. Chords are indicated: E (measure 5), A (measure 6), B7 (measure 7), and E (measure 8). Measure 8 includes a triplet of eighth notes and a fermata over the final note.

Variation 1

Variation 1 of the musical notation (measures 9-12) in treble clef, key of A major. The melody continues with eighth and sixteenth notes. Chords are indicated: A (measures 9-10), B7 (measure 11), and E (measure 12). Measure 12 includes a triplet of eighth notes and a fermata over the final note.

A D E A
 A B7 E
 A D E A
 E A₁ B7 E
 A B7 E A
 E A B7 E
 A B7 E A

Source: Terry Morris, For the Record; variation 1 by Chris Daring.

Cuckoo's Nest

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D A7 C G

D G D A7 D

D A7 C G

D G D A7 D

{B}

D C

D G D A7 D

D C

D G D A7 D

Notes: Interestingly, _The Fiddler's Bible_ reverses the order of parts.

The Democratic Hornpipe

a.k.a. Galway Bay

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Em G

Em D B7 Em

{B}

Em G D

G D G D B7 Em

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ (transposed to Em)

Notes: A really interesting tune with a lot of movement. Also frequently played in Gm, but I don't want the guitarists to murder me. Chording is still tentative.

The Derry Reel

Eugene O'Donnell?
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Part A (4 staves):
Staff 1: Chords A, E, A, D
Staff 2: Chords A, E, A, E, A
Staff 3: Chords A, E, A, D, 3
Staff 4: Chords A, E, A, E, A, 3

Part B (4 staves):
Staff 1: Chords F#m, E, F#m, E, F#m
Staff 2: Chords A, E, A, E, A
Staff 3: Chords F#m, E, F#m, E, F#m, 3
Staff 4: Chords A, E, A, E, A, 3

Notes: Cobbled from two versions found at thesession.org/tunes/7671. I really like the B-part!

The Durham Hornpipe

*James Hill
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

E E F#m B7 A E A B7

E F#m B7 A E B7 | 1 E | 2 E

{B}

B7 E G#m C#7

E A B7 A E B7 | 1 E | 2 E

Source: _The Lads Like Beer_

Notes: A hornpipe in E! Nice! Like many Hill tunes, it has some twisty bits.

Fisher's Hornpipe (D)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

System 1 (A):
 Staff 1: D G D G D G D A
 Staff 2: D G D G A D
 Staff 3: D G D G D G D A
 Staff 4: D G D G A D

System 2 (B):
 Staff 1: A D A A
 Staff 2: G D A D
 Staff 3: A D A A
 Staff 4: G D A D

Notes: This is commonly played in either D or F major. Here are some examples of it in D, sourced and adapted from various transcriptions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Fisher's Hornpipe (F)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F C

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ C F

{B}

C F C C

B $\flat$ F C F

{A} (var.)

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F C

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ C F

{C}

F B $\flat$ F C

B $\flat$ F C F

3

Notes: Here's the F version as I learned it, along with a nice variation on the A-part I found at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Gin Rickshaw

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D Em D G D A7

D Em D A7 D

D Em D G D A7

D Em D A7 D

{B}

D G D A7

D G A7 D

D G D A7

D G A7 D

Hummingbird Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

A E A E A

{B}

A E A

The Humours of Tulla

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D D Em D G A7

D D Em D G A7

{B}

D D G D G A7

D D G D G A7

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/141>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! First comes the basic melody, then my variations.
The G and Em chords are fairly interchangeable. I mix and match them in this arrangement.

The Kitchen Girl

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 110$
{A}

A G A A E7

A G A G E7 A

{B}

Am G Am Am E7

Am G Am Am G Am

Variation

A G A A E7

A G A G E7 A

Am G Am Am E7

Am G Am Am G Am

Source: Kentucky Open Band Contra Tunes, with some original variations.

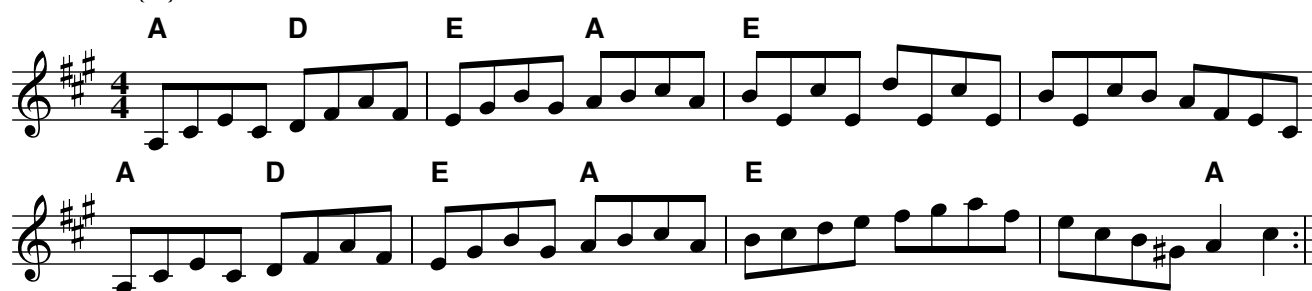
Notes: Great jam tune. For inspiration, see https://youtu.be/912wUcMXG_0?feature=shared

Miller's Reel

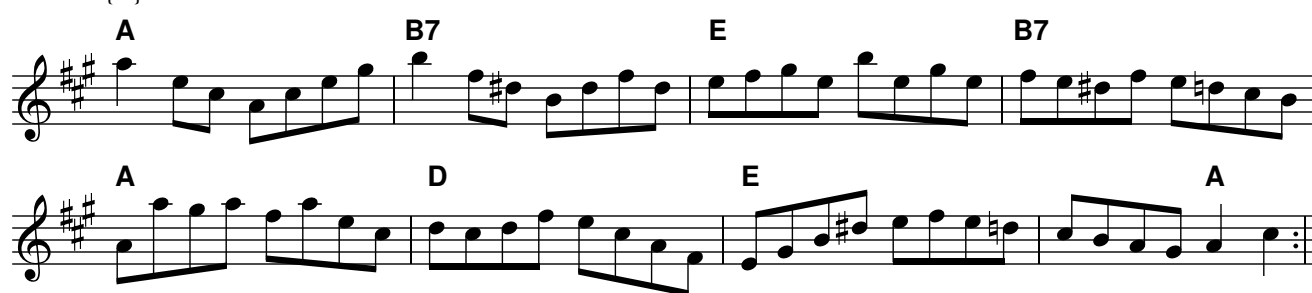
*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}



{B}



Money Musk

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A} (2 variations)

Section {A} (2 variations) musical notation. The first staff shows the initial key signature change and the start of the melody. The second staff continues the melody. Chords A, D, A, E7, A, D, E7, A are indicated above the notes.

{B} (2 variations)

Section {B} (2 variations) musical notation. The first staff shows the melody. The second staff continues the melody. Chords A, A, E7, A, E7, A are indicated above the notes.

{C} (4 variations)

Section {C} (4 variations) musical notation. The first staff shows the melody. The second staff continues the melody. The third staff continues the melody. The fourth staff continues the melody. Chords A, Bm, E7, A, D, E7, A are indicated above the notes.

D-part

D-part musical notation. The staff shows the melody. Chords A, D, A, E7, A, D, E7, A are indicated above the notes.

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ for the base, plus variations by Tom Wiesgerber.

Notes: Great tune with oodles of variations! Choose your favorite version(s) of A, B, and C, then play: Ax2 > Bx2 > Cx2 or D (some play both) > repeat from the top.

The Morpeth Rant

William Sheild
rant

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D G A D G A

D G A D G A D

D G A D G A

D G A D G A D

{B}

D G Em A D

D G Em A D

D G Em A D

D G Em A D

Source: Stewart Hardy, <https://youtu.be/ogZMXmpvqh4?si=OReaCGFonFyUaiGt>.

Notes: The unofficial "national" tune of Northumberland. It is popular to play this in a set with The Old Morpeth Rant and Roxburgh Castle.

The Old Morpeth Rant

*Trad.
rant*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A} G C G Am D7

1 G C G D7 G 3

2 G C G D7 G

{B} G D7 C Am D7

1 C D7 G D7 G

2 C D7 G D7 G

Source: Stewart Hardy, https://youtu.be/d0AWDc_zuK0?si=Nra7JSgGlfhzKS1A.

Notes: More regional interest: the rant is a local form, connected with the Rapper Sword dance;
"musically it is similar to a reel, though somewhat slower, and with more of a lilt."
(https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Music_of_Northumbria). Some also play it in Bb.

The Mortgage Burn

Gordon MacLean
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: A, A, Bm, Bm, E7, A, Bm, E7, A, A, C#m, D, A, Bm, F#m, E, A, A, C#m, D, A, Bm, F#m, E, A, A, F#m, C#m, D, A, F#m, E, A.

Source: _Ho-Ro-Gheallaidh vol. 3_; <https://thesession.org/tunes/2047>

Notes: Wild chord changes in the {B} part! Love it!

New Reel

*Dale Morris
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}



{B}



Notes: A somewhat mysterious tune I found amongst the practice / lesson tapes from Dale Morris that my teacher passed on to me. I only have it down as "New Reel" (was it Dale's composition?), but it might be a traditional tune.

da New Rigged Ship + Shelder Geo

pronounced "gyo"

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

da New Rigged Ship

Chords for 'da New Rigged Ship':

- Staff 1: A, G, D
- Staff 2: A, G, D
- Staff 3: A, E7, A, E7, A, E7, 1 A, 2 A
- Staff 4: Am, G, Am, Em, Am, G, Am

Shelder Geo

Chords for 'Shelder Geo':

- Staff 1: D, C, G, D, G, D
- Staff 2: C, C, C, D
- Staff 3: C, C, C, D

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990).

Notes: This set segues nicely to Sleep Soond i da Moarnin.

The Nine Points of Roguery

a.k.a. The Black Mare of Fanad

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A} D G D Bm Em 3



{B}

C G D Bm Em 3



{A'}

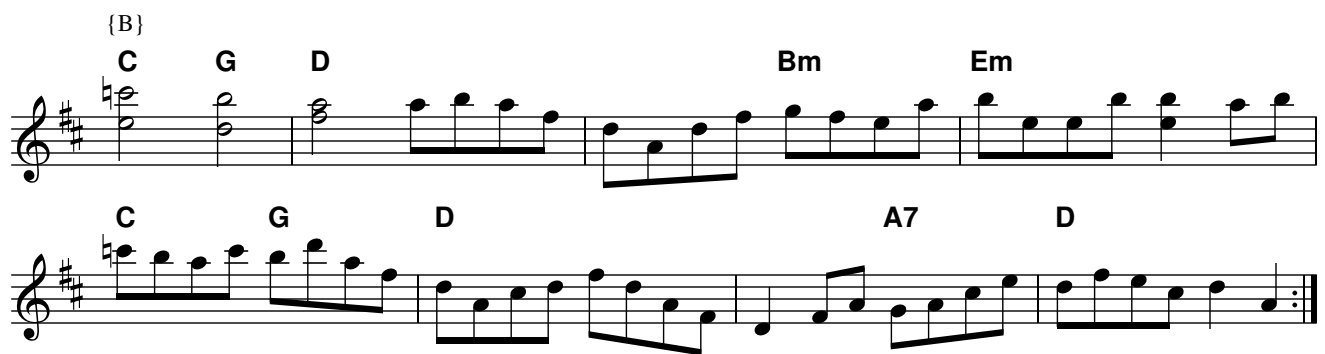
D G D Bm Em 3



{B}

C G D Bm Em

C G D A7 D



Variation 1

D G D Bm Em

D G D A7 D



The musical score is written for guitar in D major (two sharps: F# and C#). It consists of six staves, organized into two systems of four staves each. The first system contains staves 1 through 4, and the second system contains staves 5 through 6. The music is a single melodic line with various chords indicated above the staff. The chords are: C, G, D, Bm, Em, A7, and D. The melody includes triplets (marked with a '3') and specific fingerings (marked with numbers 1, 3, 4). The piece ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Source: _Ho-ro-gheallaidh_ vol. 1; Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990); my own additions.

Notes: Maggie plays over a C chord on the 4th measure of every part; I really like that, but it seems that going to Em is far more common. Plus it makes the C really pop when we get to the {B} part.

Old Joe Clark

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105
{A}

The A section consists of two staves of music in 4/4 time. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written on a single staff. The notes are: A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C#5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G#4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (half). The first staff ends with a double bar line. The second staff continues the melody: A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C#5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G#4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (half). The section ends with a double bar line.

{B}

The B section consists of two staves of music in 4/4 time. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written on a single staff. The notes are: A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C#5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G#4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (half). The first staff ends with a double bar line. The second staff continues the melody: A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C#5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G#4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (half). The section ends with a double bar line.

Notes: This is a popular bluegrass tune. Here is a simple version I got from a mandolin lesson. Will work with this more in the future.

Old Straw Bonnet

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G F G D

G F G C D

{B}

G F

G C D G

{C}

Gm D7

Gm D7

1 Gm 2

Notes: Great tune; this is the basic way I play it.

Opera Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}.1

D A D G A

D D A D G A

{A}.2

D D A D G A 3

D D A D G A

{B}.1

D A D G D G A D

D A D G D G A D

{B}.2

D A D G D G A D

D A D G D G A D³

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and some online variants

Notes: This is interesting! Basically the usual A and B parts, but each part seems to have distinct variations on each. It's got a great build.

Peerless Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Chords: C, G7, C, F, C, G7, C, G7

Measures 1-8 of the first system. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The time signature is 4/4. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes. Measure 7 contains a triplet of eighth notes. Measure 8 ends with a double bar line.

{B}

Chords: G, C, D7, G, G7, C, G7, C

Measures 9-16 of the second system. Measure 9 starts with a repeat sign. Measure 10 contains a sharp sign (#) before the first note. Measure 14 ends with a double bar line.

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

Petronella

reel

$\text{♩} = 105$



Devil



Maxwell



Linton



St Annes



♩ = 105

{A} D A D G

D A D A

D G 1 A D 2 A D

{B}

A D G E

E A A D

G A 1 D 2 D

Rackety Jack's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G D

G C D D G

{B}

G C G D

G C D D G

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

The Rights of Man

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Em G D C Bm

Em G D Em

{B}

G Em G Em D Bm

C Am Em Am D Em

Notes: Popularly paired with The Democratic Hornpipe.

Also features in the set: King of Fairies > Off to California > Rights of Man.

Roxburgh Castle

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G C G C Am D7

G C G G D7 G

{B}

G C G Am D7

G C G D7 G

Source: <https://thesession.org/tunes/4628>

Rye Straw (D)

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

A D A D A D E A

A D A D A D E A

{B}

A D A G D

A D A D E A

{C}

D G D A D

G A D A A D D.C.

Source: Todd Phillips + Darol Anger, *In the Pines* (1995) [with many modifications]

Notes: Rye Straw seems to have a zillion variations. The core of this version draws from Darol Anger's arrangement, where he seems to mash the 16 bars of one of its usual B-parts to create a 'bridge' C-part of 10 bars. It's pretty neat!

Rye Straw (D) v.2

Trad. + Dave Notman
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

A D

A 1 D 2 D

{B}

A D A D D 1 G A 2 G A

Notes: A version of Rye Straw heavily modified by Dave Notman.

Rye Straw (G)

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G C G C D G

G C G C G C D G

{B}

G C D G

G C D G

Source: Doc Roberts, followed by a few variations I've heard.

Notes: Note about the chords - this can easily follow a straight G pattern, but I kind of like the "rocking" pattern between G and C on the A part that I've heard in other versions.

Saint Anne's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D A D G D

D A D G A D

D A D G D

D A D G A D

{B}

D G A D

D G A D

D G A D

D G A D

Source: A combination of two versions at thesession.org/tunes/103

Notes: A rather jaunty tune, with a nice melody. Something to explore?

Sally Growler

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G C G A D

G C G C G D G

{B}

G G D7 D7

G G D7 G

3

Salt Creek

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A} A A D G

G E A A D

1 A E A 2 A E A

{B} A A G G

A A A E A

Source: An online intro to mandolin tutorial

Notes: VERY similar to Salt River, but the B-part is different

Salt River

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A}

Musical notation for the first system of 'Salt River', measures 1-8. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on four staves. Chord labels A, G, D, and E are placed above the notes. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some triplets indicated by a '3' over a group of notes.

{B}

Musical notation for the second system of 'Salt River', measures 9-16. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on two staves. Chord labels A, G, and E are placed above the notes. The melody continues with eighth and sixteenth notes, including a triplet in measure 14.

{A}

Musical notation for the third system of 'Salt River', measures 17-24. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on four staves. Chord labels A, G, D, and E are placed above the notes. The melody continues with eighth and sixteenth notes, including triplets in measures 17 and 18.

{B} (low, play in 3rd position)

Musical notation for the fourth system of 'Salt River', measures 25-28. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on one staff. Chord labels A, G, and E are placed above the notes. The melody continues with eighth and sixteenth notes.



Notes: So this is clearly the same base tune as Salt Creek, but it has drifted in different directions, depending on who is playing it. This version is based on Terry and Dale Morris's.

Saratoga Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

First system of musical notation (measures 1-8) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (Bb) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the notes: F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F.

{B}

Second system of musical notation (measures 9-16) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (Bb) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the notes: Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, C.

{A}

Third system of musical notation (measures 17-24) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (Bb) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the notes: F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F, Bb, F, G, C.

The musical score is written for guitar in B-flat major (one flat). It consists of five staves of music. The first staff shows the key signature and the first four measures with chords F, B-flat, F, G, C, and F. The subsequent four staves are marked with a {B} brace, indicating a B-section. These staves contain a series of eighth-note patterns with chords Dm, A7, and C. Triplet markings (3) are present at the end of the second, third, and fourth staves. The final staff concludes the section with a C chord.

Chords indicated above the staff:

- Staff 1: F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F
- Staff 2: Dm, Dm, A7, A7
- Staff 3: Dm, Dm, A7, Dm
- Staff 4: Dm, Dm, A7, A7
- Staff 5: Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, C

Source: Assembled from versions by Chris Daring, Terry Morris, Christine King, and Tom Weisgerber.

Shetland Set

da Ferry Reel, Lay Dee at Dee, and Miss Spencie's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

♩ = 105

Ferry Reel

Chord progression for Ferry Reel: D, D, Bm, G, Em, A, D, Bm, G, A, A, B $\flat$ 0, Bm, G, A, D.

Lay Dee at Dee

Chord progression for Lay Dee at Dee: D, D, D, A, D, D, A, A, Bm, G, A, D.

Miss Spencie's Reel

Chord progression for Miss Spencie's Reel: D, C, G, D, D, A, D, A, D.

Source: See, e.g. Aly Bain and Tom Anderson, *The Silver Bow: The Fiddle Music of Shetland* (2016).

Notes: This is a common set.

The Silver Spear

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Section {A} consists of four staves of music in 4/4 time, key of D major. The melody is written in treble clef. Chords are indicated by letters D, G, A, and D above the notes. The first staff contains measures 1-4, the second staff contains measures 5-8, the third staff contains measures 9-12, and the fourth staff contains measures 13-16. The melody is a continuous line of eighth and sixteenth notes.

{B}

Section {B} consists of four staves of music in 4/4 time, key of D major. The melody is written in treble clef. Chords are indicated by letters D, G, A, and D above the notes. The first staff contains measures 17-20, the second staff contains measures 21-24, the third staff contains measures 25-28, and the fourth staff contains measures 29-32. The melody is a continuous line of eighth and sixteenth notes.

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/182>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! Popularly paired with Maid Behind the Bar.

Sleep Soond i da Moarnin'

Sleep Sound in the Morning

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Am G Em Am G Am

Am G Em Am G Am

{B}

Am G Am G Am

Am G Am G Am

{B} (var.)

Am G Am G Am

Am G Am G Am

Source: Maggie Sansone, *_Mist and Stone_* (1990).

Notes: Note on the B-part variant: I don't know why, but I always want to play the last C of the rising run as a C#. I know it's out of the key, but I think it sounds awesome.

Smith's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

{B}

Bm G D Bm E7 A7

D Bm G D Bm A7 D

Bm G D Bm E7 A7

D Bm G D Bm A7 D

{A} (var.)

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G $\overset{3}{D}$ Bm $\overset{3}{A7}$ D

Source: Cameron Cross and Joey McKensie

Notes: I've seen some versions where the first chord in the A-part is Bm. I want to like it, but it sounds a little off.

The Spinning Dogs of Carrowkennedy

Damian Caisley
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Chords and triplets are indicated above the notes. The key signature is G major (one sharp). The time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute.

Notes: Inspired by the sight of two "absolutely mental" dogs spinning around each other in Carrowkennedy. It has a fun "bridge" part you can surprise your friends with. Recommended order is to play through the regular tune {A-B} twice, then on the third time through include the bridge and finish on {B}.

The Stage Hornpipe

James Hill
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: {A}, G, G, Am, D7, G, C, D7, D7, G, G, Am, Am, D, Am, G, G, Am, D7, G.

Source: Adapted from <https://thesession.org/tunes/1249>

Notes: Tricky! I think the best way to play the {B} part is to shift to second position.

The Twenty-Eighth of January

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

{B}

Am Am G G Em

Am Am G Em Am

{A} (var.)

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

{B} (var.)

Am Am G G

Am Am G Em Am

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and thesession.org/tunes/15717 for the base

Notes: Now this is an interesting number! The A-part uses the "Dorian vamp," pretty unusual in fiddle tunes but a staple in classic rock. Seems like a popular bluegrass tune.

Westmoreland's Hornpipe

Terry Morris
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D 4 0 Em D 4 0 A V V

D 4 0 Em A 4 1 A D 2 A D

{B}

D G D A

D 4 0 Em A 4 1 D 2 D

{A}

D Em D A

D 4 0 Em A 4 A D

Source: Terry Morris, *_Touch of Texas_* (1976)

Notes: Very pretty tune. I've marked alternating closed and open strings to give it more tonal variety.

Whiskey Before Breakfast

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105

{A}

Chords: D, G, D, Em, A, D, G, D, A7, D

{B}

Chords: D, Em, A7, D, A, G, D, G, D, A, D

{A}

Chords: D, G, D, 3, Em, A, D, G, A7, D

{B}

Chords: D, 3, 3, Em, A7, D, A, G, D, G, D, A, D

Source: Cameron Cross

Notes: Classic, beautiful tune. Rough transcription of how I like to play it.

---JIGS AND SLIPJIGS---

The Ballykeal Jig

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

F F G G

F F D 1 G 2 G

G D G D

G D D 1 G 2 G

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Chords very tentative (again).

Brose and Butter + Cuzle Together

BB a.k.a. The Peacock Followed The Hen

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

Am G Am G C G C D G

Bonnie's variation

A G A G A G D G

Cuzle Together

A G A D G A D G

Edor version by Fraser and Haas

Em D Em D G A G D Em D Em D

Source: Bonnie Rideout, *_Scottish Fire_* (2000); A. Fraser and N. Haas, *_Fire & Grace_* (2004).

Notes: Bonnie plays this on the viola and it sounds awesome. I've transposed it up a fifth to work on the fiddle. Another interesting thing is that she switches between A dorian (with a C natural) - which seems to be the standard - and mixolydian (C sharp). She combines B&B with Cuzle Together, another slipjig also in Amix (as well as Elsie Marley). This is supplemented with a version in Edor by Fraser and Haas, with a nice B-part.

The Butterfly

Tommy Potts
slipjig

$\text{♩} = 100$
{A}

Em D Em Bm Em D C D

{B}

C Bm Am7 D

{C}

G G D G C D

A-part: Em/D Em/Bm Em/D C/D :|

B-part: C .. Bm .. Am · D · :|

C-part: G .. G/D · G .. C/D :| (The Gs can be substituted for Em's if preferred)

Source: The Good Tune

Notes: I've modified the bowing to something that makes more sense to me. But of course this is just a model to be played with.

Elsie Marley

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score for "Elsie Marley" is written in 9/8 time, key of D major (two sharps). The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The score consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a key signature change to D major. The music is a traditional slipjig, characterized by its 9/8 time signature and lively, bouncy melody. The score includes various musical notations such as eighth and sixteenth notes, beamed notes, and slurs. Chords are indicated by letters A, D, G, and Em above the staff. Up-bows are marked with a 'v' above a note. The piece is divided into two main sections, each with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

Source: Horseplay (Roughshod, 2006), with a few tweaks

Notes: A great romp of a tune. I find it helpful to "pop" the up-bows where marked.

The Maid At The Spinning Wheel

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in G major (one sharp) and 6/8 time. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The piece consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a G chord. The second staff has G, G, D, and first/second endings marked '1 G' and '2 G'. The third staff has G, D, D, and D chords. The fourth staff has G, D, D, and first/second endings marked '1 G' and '2 G'. The fifth staff has G, D, G, D, A, and D chords. The sixth staff has G, D, G, D, A, and first/second endings marked '1 G' and '2 G'. The piece concludes with a final G chord.

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

The Yorkshire Trip

a.k.a. Danish Slipjig

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A}

Section A (Measures 1-4):

Staff 1: G, C, G, D, G, C, D

Staff 2: G, C, G, D, G, C, D

{B}

Section B (Measures 5-8):

Staff 1: C, G, C, D, C, G, D

Staff 2: C, G, C, D, C, G, D

{C}

Section C (Measures 9-12):

Staff 1: Em, D, C, D

Staff 2: Em, D, C, D

A-part: G/G/C G/G/D G/G/C D :|

B-part: C/G/G C/D/D C/G/G D :|

C-part: Em .. D ... C ... D :|

Source: William Vickers' Collection of Dance Tunes (1770); The Good Tune
Notes: A very nice slipjig; the sixteenth notes in the first part give it a distinctive touch.

---TUNES OF CHOICE---

The Blackbird (Set Dance)

*Trad.
set dance*

$\text{♩} = 80$

{A}

Chords: G, Am, D, A, C

Part {A}:

Staff 1: G, Am, D, G

Staff 2: D, D, A, D

Staff 3: G, Am, D, G

Staff 4: D, D, G 3, D

Part {B}:

Staff 1: D, A, D, G, G, D

Staff 2: D, A, D, G, D

Staff 3: D, G, C, C, G

Staff 4: D, C, G, D

Source: Bobby Gardiner (Memories of Claire, 1996), with my own variations.
Notes: Lovely tune! Unusually (as far as I know), each part ends with an extra two beats.
Has a strong melodic sympathy with the Blackbird Hornpipe. D mixolydian, chords tentative.

Codladh na madraí fada

(Sleep of the Long Dogs)

James Jackson, 2026
air

♩ = 115

Em D G D C G Am Bm

Em D G D C G Bm Em

Em D C D G D Am D

Em D C D C G Bm Em

A-part: Em D G D | C G Am Bm || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

B-part: Em D C D | G D Am D || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

Source: James Jackson

Notes: Written as a lament over the site of a mass grave of greyhounds; see
<http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/england/wear/6457185.stm>. Play slowly with feeling and ornamentation.

Jezebel Carol

*Trad.
carol*

$\text{♩} = 160$

B min Bm A

Bm D A

Bm A

Bm F#m A Bm

A min Am G

Am C G

Am G

Am Em Am

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990); Áine Minogue (Between the Worlds, 1997).

Notes: This interesting tune has an extra beat at the end. I've also found it played in both A and B minor. Chords remain tentative.

The Old Crossroads

a.k.a. Down The Brae

*Trad.
march*

♩ = 130

Em Em G Em D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Em Em G D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990)

---WALTZES---

11.30 in Mallaig

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 150

A D G Em A D Em G

A D Bm A G D A 1 2

Bm D A G D Em G

Bm D A G D A 1 2

Source: Horseplay (Roughshod, 2006)

Notes: BEAUTIFUL melody. I'm still feeling out the chords.

Ameila('s Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 160$

{A}

D D Bm F#m

G D Bm G

D D Bm F#m

G G A

1 3 2

{B}

D D A A

Bm Bm F#m F#m

G D A D

G D A D

Source: Natalie MacMaster (A Compilation, 1996)

Notes: Play it heavily swung.

(The) April (Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 180

Chords: G, D, C, D, Bm, Em, C, G, D7, G, Dsus, Em, C, G, Em, C, D, Em, Em, C, D, Em, C, G, D, C

Captain O'Kane

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 180$

{A}

Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em

{B}

Em Em D Bm Am G Bm Em G Em7 D Bm G Am Em Em

Source: Loosely adapted from Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Can make some great harmonies! I added a high part for reference.

The Ken Meadows Waltz

Martin Matthews
waltz

$\text{♩} = 115$

{A} F#m A II

D 1 A E 2 A E 3 A

{B} E A II

D 1 A E 2 A 3 A

{C} E A II

D A E A 3 A 3

A II D A E 3 A

Two Rivers

Larry Unger (1986)
waltz

$\text{♩} = 180$ **Bm** **F#m**

Bm **G** **A**

D **F#m**

Bm **A** | 1 **G** | 2 **G**

Bm **A**

Bm **G** **A** **Bm**

Bm **G** **A** **Bm**

F#m | 1 **G** **A** | 2 **G** **A**

Source: _The Curvy Road to Corinth_ by Larry Unger.

Notes: Written at a campsite on Lake Michigan in Two Rivers, WI.